An official website of the United States government Here's how you know

Celebrating SBA's 73rd birthday with a brand-new SBA.gov

We've redesigned the site in honor of America 250 and to help you find what you need faster.

You can also visit the legacy site here.

Plan your business

Plan to make your great idea into a great small business using SBA's data and trend resources, business plan templates and startup cost calculator.

Market research and competitive analysis

Learn about market research

Write your business plan

Learn about business plans

Calculate your startup costs

Learn about startup costs

Help us improve

Establish business credit

Learn about business credit

Fund your business

Learn how to fund your business

Buy an existing business or franchise

Learn about buying a business

Need help? Get free business counseling

Find counselors

Market research and competitive analysis

Market research helps you find customers for your business. Competitive analysis helps you make your business unique. Combine them to find a competitive advantage for your small business.

Use market research to find customers +

Use competitive analysis to find a market advantage +

Free small business data and trends +

Write your business plan

Your business plan is the foundation of your business. Learn how to write a business plan quickly and efficiently with a business plan template.

Business plans help you run your business +

Pick a business plan format that works for you +

Calculate your startup costs

How much money will it take to start your small business? Calculate the startup costs for your small business so you can request funding, attract investors, and estimate when you'll turn a profit.

Calculate your business startup costs before you launch +

Break-even point +

Identify your startup expenses +

Estimate how much your expenses will cost +

Add up your expenses for a full financial picture +

Use your startup cost calculations to get startup funding +

Establish business credit

As you work to understand your startup costs and expenses, you'll also want to make sure your credit is in good stead. Poor credit history is one of the main reasons why loan applications for small businesses are often declined. Poor credit history can also impact insurance rates and the attractiveness of your business to potential partners, suppliers, and vendors.

That's why cultivating and maintaining good credit scores — for both your personal and business lines of credit — is so important.

Maintain good personal and business credit history +

Apply for business credit +

Check and monitor your credit

Fund your business

- Determine how much funding you'll need +
- Fund your business yourself with self-funding +
- Get venture capital from investors +
- Use crowdfunding to fund your business +
- Get a small business loan +
- Use Lender Match to find lenders who offer SBA-guaranteed loans +
- SBA investment programs +

Buy an existing business or franchise

Starting a business from scratch can be challenging. Franchising or buying an existing business can simplify the initial planning process.

Know the difference between franchising and buying a business +

Consider three factors before franchising or buying a business +

Get ready to buy your franchise or business +

SBA Franchise Directory +

Report fraud or identity theft

Red Tape Hotline

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Legacy website

